

Student Planner App: UX Research Case Study

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Understanding how college students manage coursework and deadlines

Project Overview

College students often use multiple applications to manage coursework, resulting in missed deadlines and increased stress. This project explores how a centralized planner could improve organization.

Problem Statement

Many college students use multiple tools—including learning management systems, calendars, notebooks, and reminder apps—to manage coursework. Constantly switching between these platforms can lead to missed deadlines, increased stress, and difficulty prioritizing assignments. This research explores how a centralized student planner could simplify organization and improve the overall academic experience.



Research



Interviews

Conducted interviews with five college students to understand their study habits, planning methods, and organizational challenges.



Survey

Gathered additional feedback about preferred planning tools, reminder systems, and desired app features.



Competitive Analysis

Evaluated existing productivity applications to identify strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities for improvement.



Survey



Participant 1



Full-time Student



Part-time Employee



Uses Google Calendar



Misses deadlines.



Participant 2



Full-time Student



Uses Google Calendar



Survey



Participant 3



Full-time Student



Uses Notebook and School System



Participant 4



Full-time Student



Uses a paper planner and a digital calendar.



Survey



Participant 5



Part-time Student



Full-time Employee



Uses Phone Reminder App



Struggles to balance work, school, and personal commitments across multiple apps.



Findings



Research Highlights

80%

wanted one dashboard

80%

preferred customizable reminders

60%

found switching between apps frustrating

100%

wanted a simpler interface

Overall Insight: Students consistently expressed a desire for a single application that combines assignment tracking, reminders, and calendar management into one easy-to-use experience.

User Persona

Alex, 21

Background

- Full-time college student
- Works part-time

Goals

- Stay organized
- Submit assignments on time
- Reduce stress

Frustrations

- Uses multiple apps
- Misses deadlines
- Hard to prioritize coursework

Needs

- One dashboard
- Calendar integration
- Custom reminders

User Journey

Step	Pain Point	Opportunity
Receive Assignment	Information scattered	Central dashboard
Record Due Date	Easy to forget	Auto-sync reminders
Complete Assignment	Hard to prioritize	Color-coded tasks
Submit Work	Last-minute stress	Progress tracking

Competitive Analysis

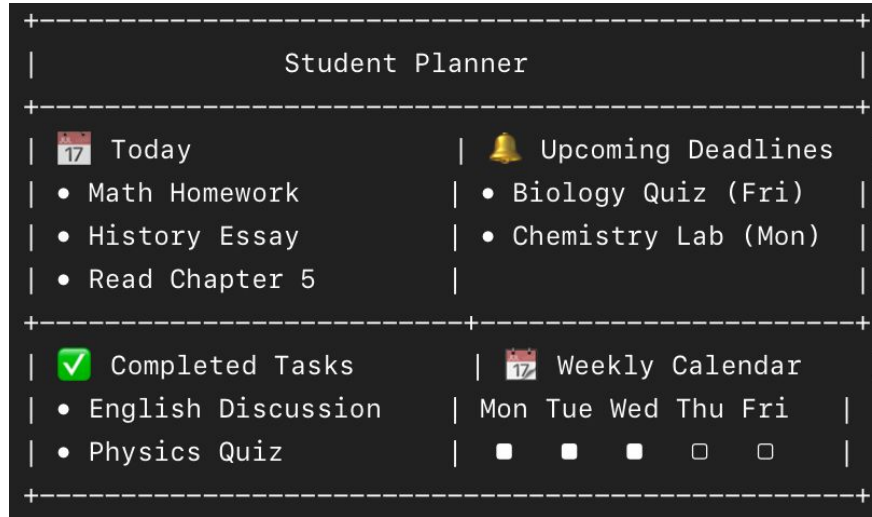
Feature	Google Calendar	Notion	Todoist	Proposed App
Reminders	✓	✓	✓	✓
Dashboard	✗	⚠	⚠	✓
Student Focus	✗	✗	✗	✓

Design Recommendations

- **Assignment Dashboard** – Keep all coursework in one location.
- **Color-Coded Priorities** – Help students identify urgent tasks.
- **Calendar Integration** – Automatically organize due dates.
- **Smart Reminders** – Reduce missed deadlines.
- **Weekly Overview** – Give students a quick snapshot of upcoming work.

Proposed Solution: Student Planner Dashboard

Based on the research findings, I designed a concept for a student planner dashboard that centralizes assignments, upcoming deadlines, and reminders in one place. The goal is to reduce the need to switch between multiple applications while helping students stay organized and prioritize their workload.



Conceptual wireframe created from research findings.

Next Steps

- Create low-fidelity wireframes
- Build an interactive Figma prototype
- Conduct usability testing
- Iterate based on user feedback

These next steps would help validate the proposed solution through iterative design and user feedback before development.

Reflection

This project strengthened my understanding of the UX research process by demonstrating how user interviews, surveys, and competitive analysis can guide design decisions. I learned the importance of identifying recurring user needs, organizing research findings, and translating those insights into practical design recommendations. If I continued this project, my next step would be to develop a high-fidelity prototype and conduct usability testing to evaluate the effectiveness of the proposed solution.

Thank You.

Thank you for reviewing my UX case study.